Writing a Site Specific Test Plan

A **site specific test plan** (shortened to **SSTP** or **test plan**) is used by the field team and clients to guide the testing process. Generally, engineering tests do not use SSTPs.

Some regulatory agencies use a **source test plan** (shortened to **STP**; also referred to as a **protocol**) instead of an SSTP. For more information on filling out an STP, go to section 9.

1. Finding your test plan in ATLAS **2**
2. Creating Your Working Document **3**
2.1 Finding Information 5
2.2 Finding Information in the Permit 11
3. Cover Page and Summary **15**
3.1 Cover Page 15
3.2 Test Program Summary 16
3.3 Table of Contents 19
3.4 Footer 20
4. Introduction **21**
4.1 A Note on RATAs 22
4.2 Maricopa County Specific Items 22
5. Summary of Test Program **23**
5.1 General Description 23
5.2 Process/Control System Parameters to be Monitored and Recorded 26
5.3 Filling Out the Proposed Test Schedule 26
5.4 Emission Limits 33
5.5 Test Report 33
6. Testing Methodology **34**
6.1 Commonly Used Methods 34
6.2 Filling Out the Methodology Section 35
7. Quality Assurance Program **41**
8. Appendices **42**
8.1 Appendix: Permit to Operate 43
8.2 Appendix: Method 1 Data 43
8.3 Appendix: Example Field Data Sheets 43
8.4 Appendix: Sample Train Diagrams 45
9. Writing an STP **47**
10. After the First Draft **49**

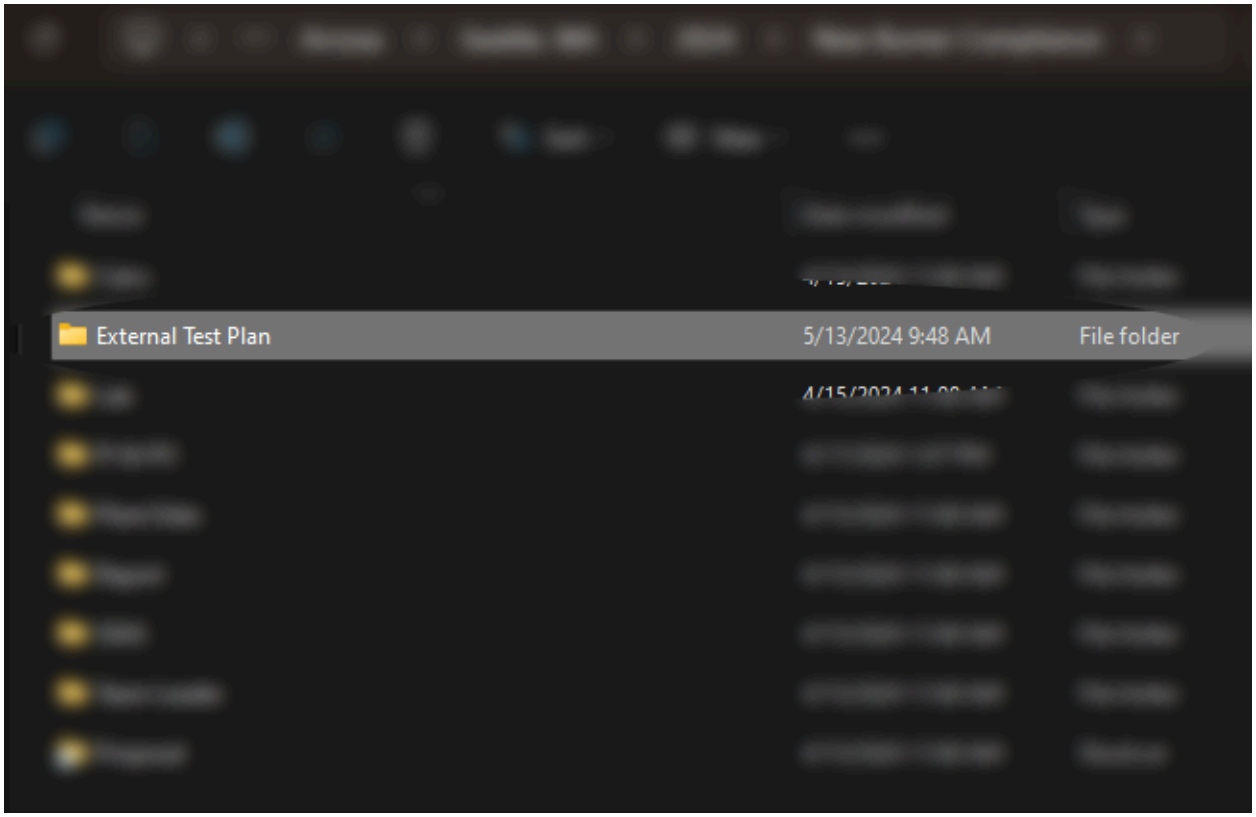
1. Finding your test plan in ATLAS

In the Test Plans window in ATLAS, your test plans will be listed with the project numbers, client information, due date, and general project information.

The test plan will be stored in the project folder. To get to the project folder from the Test Plans window, locate the row entry for the project. Find the arrow in the left-most column and right-click on it. From the drop-down list, choose "Project Folder."

2. Creating Your Working Document

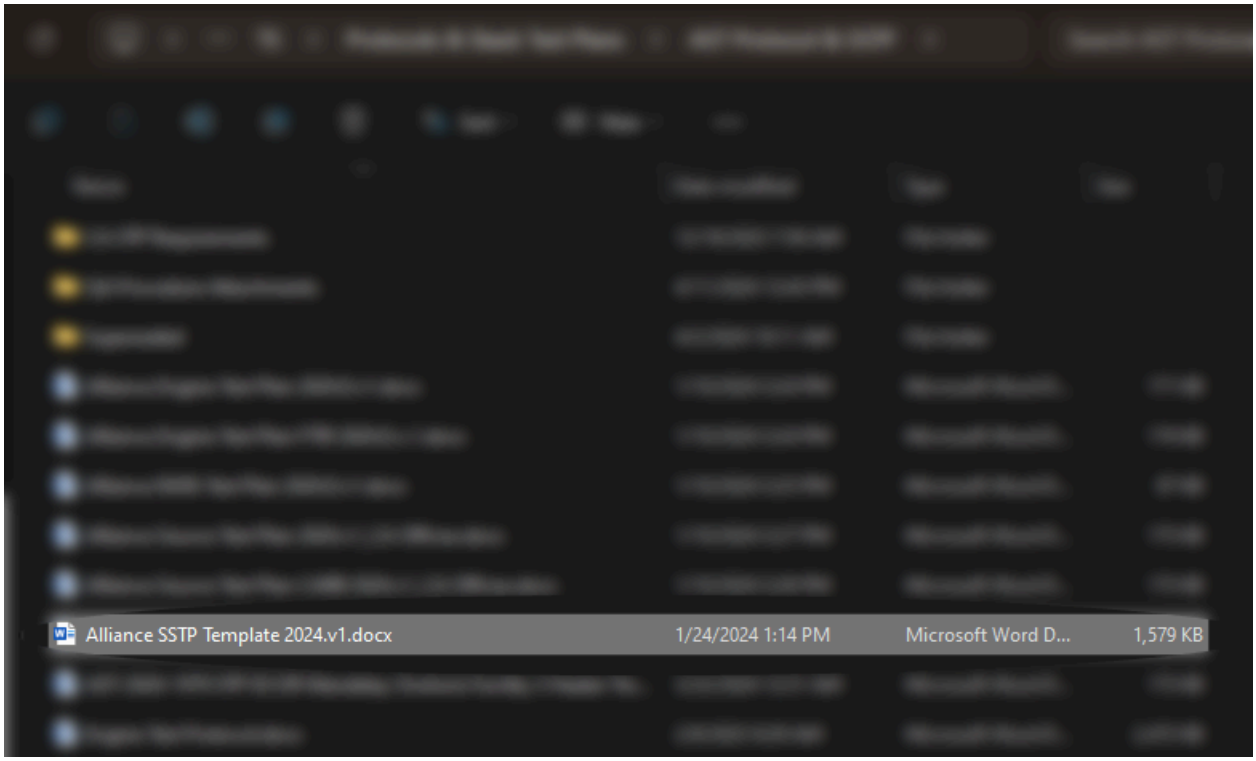
The project folder is where all data for the project is saved.



Create your test plan file in the folder titled "External Test Plan" using the latest test plan template.

1. Navigate to the "Protocols & Stack Test Plans" folder, under the path \\Alliance\Services\TS\Protocols & Stack Test Plans.

2. Open the folder titled "AST Protocol & SSTP" and locate the document named "Alliance SSTP Template".

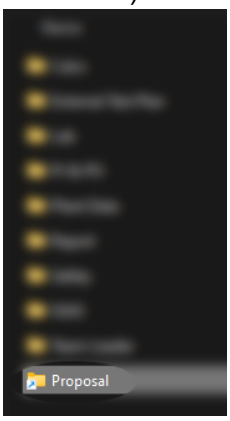
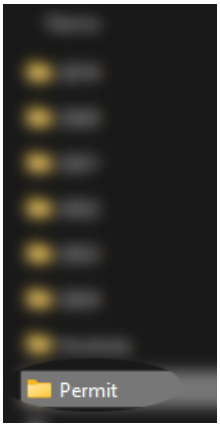


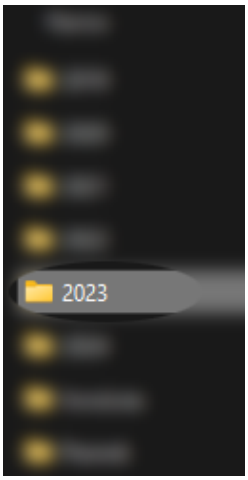
3. Copy and paste this template document into the External Test Plan folder of your project. This will be your working document. ***Make sure you don't alter or delete the original copy on the server!***
4. Rename the copied template with the appropriate project number and project name. This name is typically **"AST-####-#### [Client Name] [Source Name] [Type of Test] SSTP_draft.docx"** where
    a. **AST-####-####** is the project ID, which you can find on ATLAS.
    b. **[Client Name]** is the name of the Client, which you can find on ATLAS.
    c. **[Source Name]** is the name of the source being tested, which you can find on the proposal (Refer to Section 2.1 for instructions on how to do this).
    d. **[Type of Test]** refers to the type of test to be performed. This is usually "Comp" for compliance testing, "RATA" for RATA, or "Eng" for engineering testing.

Some states/municipalities will require additional forms for submittal. The templates for most of these forms can be found in the Protocols & Stack Test Plans folder. Your supervisor will tell you if you need additional forms.

2.1 Finding Information

Test plans describe the key aspects of a source test, namely the source(s) tested, the target parameters, testing methodology, and permits. This information can primarily be found in the proposal and permits, although previous test plans may be available to use as reference.

Document	Where do I find it?	What info can I find in it?
Proposal → The project proposal defines the objective, scope, and responsibilities of testing that Alliance has agreed to undertake for the client.	In the project folder, select the "Proposal" shortcut folder. Proposals have different IDs than the associated project (Proposal IDs end with an -S).  	See Figure 2-1 [omitted]. 1. Most recent client information 2. Type of testing 3. What sources are being tested 4. Parameters to be tested 5. Testing methods to be used 6. Number of test runs/test run duration 7. Regulatory applicability the testing is trying to meet 8. Undated proposed schedule
Permit → This document (or documents) is issued by a regulatory agency and draws the framework of allowable operations for a source or facility. This typically includes emissions limits, operating parameters, and other specific guidelines the facility must abide by.	The permit is typically found in a "Permit" folder in the project parent folder. Using file explorer, navigate outwards from the project folder until you get to the main client folder, then look for the "Permit" folder.  Otherwise, the permit may be in the proposal folder.	See Figure 2-2 [omitted]. Typically, the permit is your "last resort" for finding information because it can be tedious to sift through. The information included in the permit depends on the regulating agency, but expect to be able to find: 1. Permit number 2. Regulatory Agency 3. Facility information 4. Emission limits 5. Control unit information 6. Parameters needed to be recorded For more tips on finding information on permits, see Section 2.2.

Document	Where do I find it?	What info can I find in it?
Previous test plans → Since tests are often repeated annually or semi-annually, you may have a test plan you can use for reference. However, these are not always available. Previous test plans might not be testing the same source or be performing the same tests. Even so, these are nice to have as reference!	Previous test plans can be found in the project folders for the previous years. Navigate outwards from the project folder until you get to the main client folder.  Click through the years (you may see multiple projects under each year–Try to find a project that tests the same source as your current project) and into the "External Test Plan" folders. With luck, there will be a test plan you can use as reference here. In the case that you are able to find a repeated source test, be sure to check the permit and proposal for possible changes to the test or emissions limits. Don't assume everything is the same as last year!	See Figures 2-3 to 2-5 [omitted]. If the test plan is for the same site but not the same source: 1. Facility information 2. Regulatory agency 3. Historical client information 4. Which laboratory was used 5. Special safety requirements If it has the same source, you can also copy: 6. Regulatory citation & permit information (but check if these need to be updated!) 7. Source information 8. CEMS information (for RATA test plans) 9. Emission limits